- *Make sure that your application requires blockchain features*. Blockchain is not a solution for all applications. In other words, blockchain-based solutions and smart contracts are not panaceas for any problem you have. So what are they good for? Recall from chapter 1 that blockchain solutions are most suitable for applications that
    - Are decentralized, meaning that participants hold the assets and are not necessarily co-located
    - Involve peer-to-peer transactions without intermediaries
    - Operate beyond the boundaries of trust among unknown peers
    - Require validation, verification, and recording in a universally timestamped immutable ledger
    - Have autonomous operations guided by rules and policies
- *Make sure that you need a smart contract for your application.* Understand that the smart contract will be visible to all the participants in the chain and will be executed on the full nodes. You need a smart contract when you need a collective agreement based on rules, regulations, or policies enforced and when the decisions (and the provenance for them) must be recorded. A smart contract is not for single-node computations. It does not replace your client/server or inherently stateless distributed solutions. Smart contracts are usually part of a broader distributed application--the part that requires the services provided by the blockchain.